



PTAB Meeting Minutes: September 24, 2025

Present: Colleen O'Neill, Stacey Allott, Doug Haney, Steve Langdon, Ezra Schwartzberg, Mary Thill, Jimmy Cunningham

Meeting called to order by Chair at 6:02 p.m.

1. Approve August Meeting Minutes: Motion by Stacey Allott, Second by Mary Thill.

2. New Business:

1. **Smart Growth Grants:** Village requests letter of support from PTAB for Lake Colby Beach. Ezra requests letter of support from PTAB for Mt. Pisgah. PTAB approved.
2. **CEF Budget Allocation:** We have \$2759.83 remaining to be used by May. Some ideas from PTAB were a conceptual design created for a new bandshell at Riverside Park, replace dying trees at Riverfront Park, Rail Trail temporary wayfinding signs, art sculpture at Mt. Pisgah, or collaborate with Downtown Advisory Board to combine our CEF funds for something bigger. Colleen will send out a survey for all to vote on where majority sees priority, then we will discuss and decide at next meeting.
3. **Capital Improvement Plan (CIP):** Feedback is due by 9/26. The following projects under PTAB are listed on the CIP: Baldwin Park, Sidewalk Improvements, Garwood Park, Lake Colby Beach, Riverside Park, Boothe River Park. Prescott Park is on the CIP but we are unclear who is driving this project and where we might get involved. Colleen will reach out to John and Bachana to find out more details. Cost estimate for Riverside Park bandshell and permanent bathrooms and other improvements seems too low. We will discuss with Aurora at next meeting how CIP will impact other PTAB projects and process and what the timeline is for implementation.
4. **Adirondack Accessible Tourism ADA Assessment of Saranac Lake:** Mary Thill shared the report with PTAB. Ezra reviewed it and was impressed with the level of detail and thought it was helpful. PTAB to review and we will add it to a future meeting agenda and consider inviting back Nick Friedman of Accessible Adirondack Tourism to review it with us.

3. Unfinished Business:

1. Initiative and Park Updates

- **Baldwin Park:** Project is delayed due to APA regarding accessible kayak launch and deep water wetlands. We are in the process of getting a permit. Construction will not happen this year.
- **Boothe River Park:** Designer presented the 60% construction plans which are adjusted to remove some stepping stones in a few areas that provided alternate river access due to APA

feedback on existing deepwater wetlands. Easements work by Geomatics should be complete this week.

- **Mt. Pisgah:** Ezra is assisting the Village with applying for Smart Growth Grant and trail improvements are planned.
- **Riverfront Park:** Pruning is being done, but Ash trees are not doing well. Consider replacing them with new trees.
- **Rail Trail:** Doug and Colleen presented temporary wayfinding signage plan at Rail Trail crossings and PTAB should provide any additional feedback by Monday. Then we will submit the proposal to Aurora and ask her to add to the next Board Meeting agenda for approval. This temporary signage is in place in Lake Placid and will be in Tupper Lake in the future. ARTA and DEC want all destinations to have consistent signage. ROOST will design signs, PTAB to create and DPW to install. Steve will reach out to Julia from ARTA re: vegetation management at crossings as quite a few are overgrown and impacting visibility.
- **Riverside Park:** First steps are get conceptual design created and ask for public feedback on design and amenities. Revisit estimated cost on CIP with Village as PTAB feels that is low.
- **Ward Plumbadore Park:** Mountainscape sculpture and electrical installed. Lighting ceremony planned soon and PTAB will be invited.

4. **Adjourn** at 6:54 p.m.: Motion by Doug Haney, Second by Mary Thill.